

PROJECT PROPOSAL

Secure Volunteer and Event Coordination Platform

GROUP C262W-5103

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1. Executive Summary

Adelaide University supports community programmes that depend on volunteers. Coordinators run those programmes with the tools they have to hand: a spreadsheet for the volunteer list, email for applications, social media for advertising and paper for attendance. Personal details are copied between files and inboxes, shared with people who do not need them, and changed without any record of who changed what. The result is a standing risk of disclosure, and an administrative load that grows with every event.

We propose to design and deliver a secure, web-based Volunteer and Event Coordination Platform. Coordinators will create events, advertise volunteer roles, review applications, allocate shifts and record attendance. Volunteers will manage their own profiles and see their own activities. Each user will reach only the information their role permits, and every significant action will be recorded in an activity log that cannot be altered through the application.

The engagement will run for ten weeks across five phases. It will produce four deliverables: the platform itself, a Project Report, a Technical Document and a final presentation to the client.

The proposed fee is $86,000 excluding GST, covering 638 consulting hours, equipment, software and a contingency allowance.

2. Project Background and Description

Adelaide University supports community programmes that rely on volunteers. Coordinators run these with whatever tools they have. They use spreadsheet for the volunteer list, email for applications, social media for advertising, and paper for attendance. This causes four problems.

- **Personal information is not controlled.** A volunteer spreadsheet holds names, phone numbers, emergency contacts and sometimes health notes. Once it is emailed, copies exist in inboxes and download folders that cannot be recalled or narrowed to the fields a particular helper needs.
- **Access is all or nothing.** A coordinator who needs the roster for one event receives the entire file. There is no means of granting partial access, or of limiting a coordinator to the events they run.
- **Activity cannot be traced.** If a record is altered or disclosed, the University cannot establish who did it or what was affected. That makes the obligations set out in the Australian Privacy Principles difficult to meet.
- **Records are inconsistent.** Attendance reconstructed from paper is unreliable, which weakens reporting on volunteer contribution and makes it hard to evidence programme impact.

The proposed platform will address all four. It will support three user roles. **Volunteers** will register, maintain a profile, browse opportunities, apply for roles and view their assigned shifts. **Coordinators** will create events, define roles and shifts, publish them, decide applications, allocate volunteers and record attendance. **Administrators** will manage coordinator accounts and review the activity log.

3. Project Scope

Scope will be prioritised using the MoSCoW method. Must and Should items are committed. Could items will be delivered only if capacity permits and are listed separately below.

Inclusions

- Requirements analysis covering the volunteer and coordinator journeys.
- Security and privacy requirements analysis, including classification of personal data and agreed retention rules.
- Solution architecture, data model and interface design.
- Volunteer self-registration, sign-in, password management and account security.
- Role-based access control across three user roles, enforced by the application server.
- Volunteer profile management, including contact details, emergency contact, availability and skills.
- Event creation, editing and cancellation.
- Definition of volunteer roles and shifts, including required numbers and capacity.
- Opportunity listing, search and application, with duplicate applications prevented.
- Application review, acceptance and rejection.
- Shift allocation, including capacity limits and warnings for overlapping shifts.
- Attendance recording and correction.
- Email notification of application decisions and shift changes.
- An activity log recording sign-ins, refused access and all data changes.
- Security controls applied across the platform, with independent verification before handover.
- Functional, integration and end-to-end testing.
- The Project Report, Technical Document and final presentation.

Could items, delivered only if capacity permits: volunteer self-check-in by QR code; export of attendance and hours to a spreadsheet; duplication of an existing event.

Exclusions

- Native iOS or Android applications.
- Single sign-on or integration with University credentials.
- Integration with human resources platforms or calendar systems.
- Integration with social media platforms or SMS gateways.
- Payroll, volunteer payments or expense reimbursement.
- Background checks and working-with-children verification.
- Migration of historical volunteer records from existing spreadsheets.
- Multi-language support.
- A public marketing website or content management system.
- Penetration testing by an accredited external provider.
- Hosting, maintenance or support after handover.

4. Risks

The table below records the risks to the delivery of this project over its ten-week duration. It does not cover risks arising from the operation of the platform after handover, which will be addressed in the Project Report.

Likelihood describes how probable the event is over the project's duration, and impact describes the effect on the project's deliverables, timeframe or quality if it occurs. Mitigation strategies have been chosen to reduce either the likelihood or the impact, and the residual rating shows the position once those strategies are in place.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact and description	Risk rating	Mitigation strategies	Residual
Client availability Decisions and feedback are delayed, holding up design and build.	Likely	Moderate • Requirements confirmation is delayed. • Later phases compress, reducing quality.	High	• Agree a single client contact and a standing weekly meeting. • Batch questions into the weekly update rather than raising them piecemeal. • Proceed on a documented assumption where a decision is outstanding and confirm it in writing.	Low
Requirements change New or altered requirements arrive after the requirements baseline is agreed.	Possible	Major • Committed scope cannot be completed. • Deliverables are dropped or the schedule slips.	High	• Baseline and sign off requirements at the close of Discovery. • Assess every change for effort and schedule impact before acceptance. • Offset any addition by deferring a Should item of equal size, agreed with the client.	Low
Consultant unavailable Illness or competing commitments reduce available effort.	Likely	Moderate • Remaining team absorbs additional effort. • Dependent activities are delayed.	High	• Ensure at least two consultants understand each area of the platform. • Review availability two weeks ahead at each planning session. • Hold 112 unallocated hours to absorb reallocation.	Low
Security defects found late Verification identifies defects that cannot be corrected before handover.	Possible	Major • Rework is required close to handover. • Deliverables are accepted with known defects.	High	• Define security requirements during Discovery, not at the end. • Apply security controls progressively from Week 6. • Reserve Week 9 for verification and Week 10 for correction.	Low

Risk	Likelihood	Impact and description	Risk rating	Mitigation strategies	Residual
Effort underestimated Interface construction takes longer than planned.	Possible	Moderate • Later activities are compressed. • Should items may be deferred.	Moderate	• Confirm estimates against the agreed designs at the close of Design. • Track effort used against effort planned at each weekly review. • Defer Should items with the client if the trend does not recover.	Low
Personal data exposure Real personal data is used or exposed during development or testing.	Unlikely	Major • Privacy breach affecting the University. • Reportable incident and reputational damage.	Moderate	• Use manufactured test data only, never real volunteer records. • Restrict access to project data to the consulting team. • Agree data classification and retention rules during Discovery.	Low
Loss of work Work or project records are lost through local failure or loss of access.	Unlikely	Major • Completed work must be redone. • Phase completion dates are missed.	Moderate	• Commit all work to the shared repository daily. • Keep all project documents under shared document control. • Ensure two consultants hold administrative access to every project system.	Low
Unfamiliar technology Parts of the chosen technology stack are new to the team.	Possible	Minor • Early activities take longer than estimated. • Rework is needed as understanding improves.	Moderate	• Confirm the technology stack in Week 1 against existing skills. • Schedule accounts and access control early, while unallocated hours remain. • Pair consultants on unfamiliar work and review all changes.	Low

5. Budget

The fee below covers all consulting effort, equipment and software required to deliver the four deliverables. Consulting effort is charged at a single blended rate (based on the Hays FY25/26 South Australian) covering all members of the team, regardless of the task being performed, along with a 10% contingency.

Budget item	Calculation basis	Estimated cost (AUD)	Justification
Professional consulting services	638 hrs × $110	$70,180.00	Covers all planned work; $110/hour as per Hays' SA ranges.
Computer equipment allocation	5 consultants × $1200	$6,000.00	Allocation for laptops and peripherals, based on equipment depreciation and workspace needs.
Software, licences and tooling	Project tools	$1000.00	Development, collaboration and security tooling.
Project-wide operating allowance	5 consultants × $100	$500.00	Covers internet, electricity, phone, stationery and computer consumables used.
Travel, meetings and parking	Project allowance	$500.00	On-site workshops, reviews and the final presentation.
Baseline project cost		**$78,180.00**	Planned consulting work and operating expenses.
Contingency allowance	10% of baseline project cost	$7,818.00	Covers unforeseen but in-scope expenditure and approved additional effort.
Total estimated cost		**$85,998.00**	Total project value excluding GST.

The proposed fee is **$86,000 excluding GST**. It covers the agreed Must and Should scope and a 30-day defect correction period following handover. Additional scope, external integrations and material changes to the agreed requirements will be quoted separately.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

The engagement will be delivered by a team of five consultants. Each holds a primary delivery role and a supporting project role, so that document control and meeting records are owned rather than assumed.

Consultant	Primary Role	Responsibilities	Rationale
Tayyab Rashid	Engagement Lead	Consultant and developer. Owns the client relationship, the delivery plan and progress reporting. Leads the solution architecture, application interfaces, account management, access control and event functionality. Acts as client liaison.	Tayyab is comfortable with server-side development, so he takes primary responsibility for the platform's core. He also volunteered to coordinate the team, which makes the combined lead and developer role appropriate.
Nashan Dsouza	Environments Lead	Consultant and developer. Owns the environments, build pipeline, deployment and configuration management. Leads the data model, volunteer profiles, applications, attendance and email notifications.	Nashan preferred to focus on server-side development. His familiarity with build and environment setup supports his ownership of the infrastructure the rest of the team depends on.
Neev Aryan	Security and Test Lead	Consultant. Owns security and privacy requirements, security design, controls and verification. Owns the test approach and its execution. Maintains the risk register.	Neev has led the security work from the outset, researching secure development standards and beginning the threat assessment. Combining security with testing keeps verification with someone who did not write the code being tested.
Nguyen Duc Tung Bui	Frontend Developer	Consultant and frontend developer. Leads the coordinator requirements and interface, the requirements baseline review, and the activity log and reporting screens. Prepares the Project Report and takes meeting minutes.	Tung preferred frontend work and contributed to selecting the interface technologies. The coordinator screens are the most closely tied to the permission rules, so a single owner reduces inconsistency.
Abid Al Mamun	Frontend Developer	Consultant and frontend developer. Leads the volunteer requirements and interface, and interface consistency and accessibility. Owns document control and the shared library as Team Librarian.	Abid preferred frontend work and contributed to selecting the interface technologies. Pairing the volunteer interface with document control balances his load against the rest of the team.

Client. Adelaide University, through Wenhao Liang, will clarify requirements and workflows, confirm hosting and mail relay at kick-off, review progress, sign off the requirements baseline at the end of Phase 1, decide trade-offs and accept the deliverables.

Mentor. David Menzies will guide direction, review progress, give feedback on project management and development, and support escalation.

Communication Plan

All parties named below have agreed to these methods and frequencies.

Communication	Purpose	Method	Frequency
Client progress update	Progress against the plan, decisions required, outstanding questions	Email from the Engagement Lead	Weekly, each Friday
Client review	Confirm requirements, review progress, agree direction	Meeting, in person or online	At the close of each phase
Mentor review	Project management, progress and issues	Meeting, in person or online	Weekly
Team planning and review	Plan the week, review progress, raise obstacles	Meeting, in person or online	Twice weekly
Team communication	Day-to-day questions, availability and coordination	Messaging and email	Daily, as required
Escalation	Issues the team cannot resolve internally	Email to the mentor, client copied where relevant	Within 24 hours

Project Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	Interest in the project
Adelaide University	Client organisation	Owns the platform and the risk it manages. Requires volunteer information to be handled in line with the Australian Privacy Principles.
Wenhao Liang	Client Representative and Supervisor	Confirms requirements, approves scope decisions and accepts the deliverables.
David Menzies	Project Mentor	Guides the team’s approach, reviews progress and supports escalation.
Coordinators	Primary users	Need less administrative work, clear visibility of applications and allocations, and reliable attendance records.
Volunteers	Users and data subjects	Need to find and apply for opportunities, know when they are rostered, and trust that their details are seen only by those who need them.
University privacy and IT governance	Assurance	Interested in the controls applied, the activity log and evidence that a recognised standard was followed.
Consulting team	Delivery	Deliver the four deliverables to the agreed scope, schedule and quality, and maintain the client relationship.

7. Deliverables and Project Evaluation Criteria

The engagement will produce the following four deliverables:

#	Deliverable	Description	Due
D1	Volunteer and Event Coordination Platform	The working web application.	Week 10
D2	Project Report	A single report covering requirements, design decisions, security assurance, testing outcomes and residual risks.	Week 10
D3	Technical Document	Architecture, data model, technology selection and justification and support guidance.	Week 10
D4	Final Presentation	A demonstration of the platform and a summary of outcomes, delivered to the client and mentor.	Week 10

Evaluation Criteria

The engagement will be judged successful against the following criteria:

#	Criterion	Measure
E1	Scope delivered	Every Must scope item is working and demonstrable. Every Should item is delivered, or its omission is agreed with the client.
E2	Access control	No part of the platform returns information or accepts a change without a permission check. Attempts to reach another user's records are refused and recorded.
E3	Security verified	Security verification is completed before handover, with no unresolved high or critical findings.
E4	Delivered to plan	All five phases complete on schedule, and the four deliverables are accepted by the end of Week 10.
E5	Client acceptance	The client confirms at the final presentation that the platform and documents meet the requirements agreed at the close of Discovery.

8. Implementation Plan

Delivery will follow an iterative agile method. Work will be drawn from a prioritised backlog into one-week sprints. Security requirements will be defined during Discovery and applied progressively through construction, not added at the end. Development will follow a recognised secure development standard. OWASP ASVS Level 1 is proposed, as it defines security requirements that can be verified against a working application rather than assessing organisational maturity, and Level 1 is achievable within the given time frame. The selection will be confirmed at the close of Discovery and justified in the Technical Document.

The work will be delivered in five phases, made up of seventeen epics. The epics named below are the same epics shown as bars on the Gantt chart, so the plan and the schedule describe the same work. Each phase closes at an agreed completion point before the next phase begins. Phases overlap where the work allows, as the schedule shows.

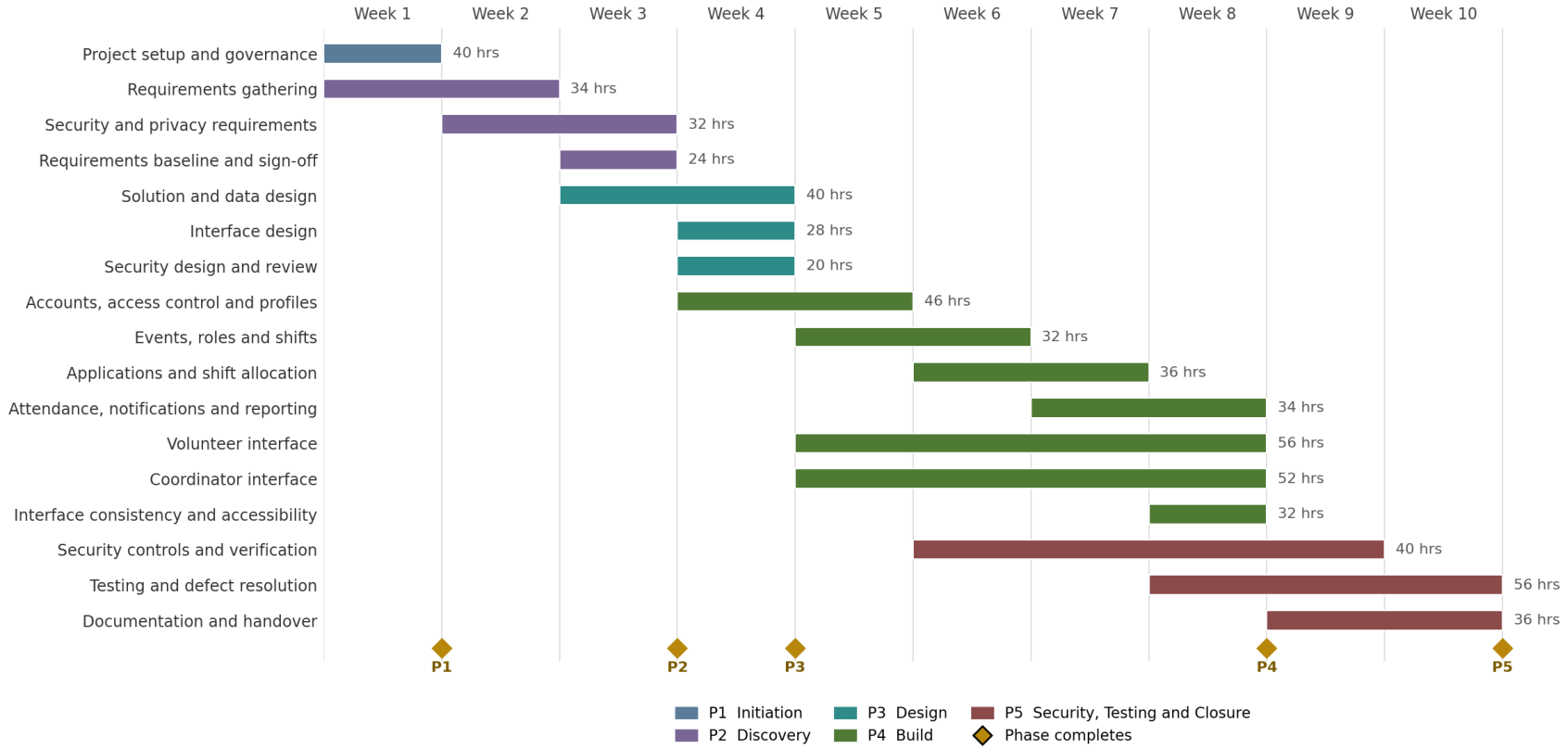
#	Phase	Weeks	Epics	Phase completes when
1	Initiation	1	Project setup and governance	Governance, environments and build pipeline are in place and the kick-off has been held with the client.
2	Discovery	1 to 3	Requirements gathering; Security and privacy requirements; Requirements baseline and sign-off	Requirements, roles, and security and privacy needs are documented and signed off.
3	Design	3 to 4	Solution and data design; Interface design; Security design and review	Architecture, data model, interface designs and security designs are approved.
4	Build	4 to 8	Accounts, access control and profiles; Events, roles and shifts; Applications and shift allocation; Attendance, notifications and reporting; Volunteer interface; Coordinator interface; Interface consistency and accessibility	All committed functionality is complete and demonstrable, and a change freeze applies.
5	Security, Testing and Closure	6 to 10	Security controls and verification; Testing and defect resolution; Documentation and handover	Security verification is complete, the platform is working and all four deliverables are accepted.

Progress will be reviewed weekly against effort planned for each phase. Where a phase runs over, the response follows a set order: draw on the unallocated hours; move work between consultants; defer Could items; and defer Should items in agreement with the client. Must items will not be deferred. If one is at risk, it will be escalated to the client and mentor immediately.

At the close of Phase 5 the University will receive the running platform, the source repository, and the Project Report, Technical Document and final presentation, all written for a maintainer who never met the team.

9. Project Schedule

The schedule runs for ten weeks, from Monday of Week 1 to Friday of Week 10, beginning on the start date confirmed at kick-off. The chart below shows the seventeen epics that make up the five phases, coloured by phase, with each phase completion point marked beneath.



Gantt chart showing seventeen epics across five phases and ten weeks

Planned effort totals 638 consulting hours across the five phases, against 750 hours available. The remaining 112 hours are held unallocated to absorb the risks set out above.

APPROVAL

The proposal for the Secure Volunteer and Event Coordination Platform project, dated 28/08/2026, is approved by:

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Tayyab Rashid	Consultant		28/08/2026
Nashan Dsouza	Consultant		28/08/2026
Neev Aryan	Consultant		28/08/2026
Nguyen Duc Tung Bui	Consultant		28/08/2026
Abid Al Mamun	Consultant		28/08/2026
Wenhao Liang	Project Supervisor		
David Menzies	Project Mentor		